Bret Lawson

Analytics & Measurement Leader | Ecommerce & Omnichannel Retail

Measurement & incrementality · Online-to-offline attribution · Forecasting · Analytics engineering · AI-native workflow

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Summary

Analytics and measurement leader with 20+ years in ecommerce and omnichannel retail who finds out why the number moved, and proves it. Measurement that holds up under challenge: attribution that reaches store transactions, holdouts and tests that settle budget arguments, decompositions that sum exactly to the observed change, forecasts that finance plans against. Builds the platform underneath it (dbt mart, pipelines, 75+ dashboards, daily anomaly monitoring) with an AI-native workflow that lets one senior person deliver what usually takes a team. Founder before enterprise leader.

Selected Results

- Decomposed a ~25% YoY organic-traffic decline into seven measured causes that sum exactly to the observed loss. Rank, the assumed culprit, explained under 1%, reframing an eight-figure revenue exposure
- Architected online-to-offline attribution for a ~2,300-store retailer: identity-stitched digital journeys to ERP transactions, ERP-calibrated, with measured stitch rates. Now the basis for channel budget allocation
- Built the finance forecast: gradient-boosted daily conversion and AOV models, holiday-tiered and walk-forward backtested; monthly, quarterly, and annual revenue forecasts within ±5%
- Stopped a brand-search budget increase that could not have worked: impression share already 96%, click elasticity to bid statistically zero, a geo holdout putting the channel near two-thirds incremental; the money went to channels with headroom
- Built AI-search measurement: sessions and stitched omnichannel sales from ChatGPT, Perplexity, Copilot, Gemini, and Claude, AI Overview citation share by connector, and a 2027 AI Overviews impact scenario finance plans against
- Built the ecommerce master mart (dbt on BigQuery): one governed daily table unifying ERP sales, web analytics, Google Ads, media, calls, and chat; the single source of truth for the executive deck, forecast, and every dashboard
- Delivered the platform around it solo: API ingestion pipelines, 76 scheduled jobs, 75+ dashboards and readouts, daily anomaly and site-health monitoring, and an automated weekly executive deck; 1,350 commits in eleven months on an AI-native workflow

Core Strengths

Measurement science	attribution (multi-touch, tiered last-touch, online-to-offline), incrementality and experiment design (geo holdouts, campaign tests, difference-in-differences, event studies, Granger causality), LMDI decomposition, media mix modeling, AI-search and AI Overview measurement
Forecasting & planning	revenue and KPI forecasting, gradient-boosted models, fiscal-calendar holiday alignment, spend-scenario and sensitivity analysis, walk-forward backtesting
Analytics engineering & delivery	dbt semantic layer, BigQuery/GCP, API ingestion, scheduled pipelines, readiness and data-quality gates, anomaly detection, metric definitions; executive decks and dashboards where every number is verifiable
AI-native workflow	Claude Code as the daily analytical workflow in the IDE, MCP data connectors (Conductor, SimilarWeb, Contentsquare); AI-assisted modeling, SQL, and documentation under human review. Rule for AI in reporting: Python computes every number, the model only narrates

Technologies

Data	BigQuery, GCP, dbt, SQL, Python (pandas, scikit-learn, XGBoost), R, HTML/CSS/JS, PowerShell, Git
Analytics	Adobe CJA, Contentsquare, Google Analytics, Tealium, Search Console, Conductor, SimilarWeb, Datadog RUM
Marketing	Google Ads (API), Adobe Advertising, Campaign Manager, Datorama, Optimizely, Adobe Target
BI & AI	Power BI, Looker Studio, Tableau, Streamlit, R Shiny, Netlify · Claude Code, MCP connectors, VS Code

Professional Experience

Senior Manager, Digital Analytics

May 2020 – Present

Mattress Firm | Houston, TX

Ecommerce analytics owner for a ~2,300-store omnichannel retailer. Led a team of 7 analysts and developers; now sole owner of the full platform on an AI-native workflow, serving finance, marketing, merchandising, operations, and retail leadership.

MEASUREMENT & CAUSAL ANALYSIS

- Decomposed a ~25% organic-traffic decline into named causes with LMDI decomposition, sessions as ground truth and third-party data directional; refuted the rank narrative and withdrew a confounded DiD

- Tested paid-to-organic spillover across 16 channels with first differences, partial correlation, bootstrap intervals, and Granger causality to separate incremental from cannibalized traffic
- Designed and read paid-search experiments: a geo holdout that put brand search near two-thirds incremental, a PLA test campaign against the prior year's best, and a Q4 incremental-spend tracker with per-campaign-type elasticities behind the holiday plan
- Measured out-of-stock cost at product and size on user journeys, price-band contribution (traffic, conversion, price) with a Shapley split on contribution dollars, and cross-sell module economics for merchandising
- Sized an $18.2M page-speed revenue opportunity and $2.1M conversion-friction loss to set tech priorities

ATTRIBUTION & METRIC GOVERNANCE

- Architected online-to-offline attribution (cross-device visitor stitching, 30-day lookback, tiered last-touch across 16 channels, ERP-calibrated), the source of truth for channel ROAS alongside media mix modeling
- Defined the canonical KPI catalog (sales, shopping conversion, AOV, contribution dollars, stitch rate, attribution windows) so every dashboard, deck, and ad-hoc answer reconciles to the same definitions

FORECASTING & PLANNING

- Built the finance forecast orchestrator (gradient-boosted daily conversion and AOV models, holiday-tiered to the fiscal calendar, walk-forward backtested) that finance and the weekly executive deck run on
- Built a CPC-based paid-search traffic engine and spend-scenario models for annual budget planning, plus an hourly intraday forecast against ERP actuals for holiday weeks
- Delivered the FY2026 off-site readout on what moved the business, each cause dated with separate 2026 and 2027 impact estimates

PLATFORM & AUTOMATION

- Modeled the mart in dbt with field definitions, a drift-checked ERD, a daily quality report, and readiness gates; engineered API ingestion (Google Ads, Contentsquare, Conductor, SimilarWeb, Datadog) and 76 scheduled jobs for pulls, refreshes, and alerts
- Wrote the dashboard house standard (metric definitions, data-integrity gates, shared date controls, formatting) and shipped 75+ dashboards and readouts plus the automated weekly executive deck against it, so numbers agree across every surface
- Built daily anomaly detection (robust z-scores against eight same-weekday baselines) across the funnel, paid search, and tag health, plus a site-health pipeline from Datadog RUM into BigQuery; turned a cart-to-checkout investigation into a reusable diagnostics playbook

Director of Customer Engagement & Digital Analytics

May 2016 – April 2020

Stage Stores | Houston, TX · Promoted April 2019 · Digital Analytics Manager 2016–2019 · **Omni-Channel Associate of the Year 2018**

- Led omnichannel analytics for an 800+ store retailer; built cross-channel attribution integrating online and offline touchpoints to guide budget allocation and reduce customer acquisition cost
- Deployed Adobe Advertising DSP analytics with geospatial targeting, a 30%+ campaign-efficiency gain
- Segmented ecommerce performance by distance-to-store bands and connected web analytics to store foot traffic for executive omnichannel KPIs

Digital Project Lead

Dec 2013 – Mar 2016

Hisco, Inc. | Houston, TX

- Led a 400,000+ SKU ecommerce platform launch in 14 months to top-of-industry conversion benchmarks with a 20+ person cross-functional team; integrated catalog, inventory, and payment systems

Founder & Owner

Jan 2003 – Sep 2013

VectorTec | Spring, TX

- Grew a specialty ecommerce retailer to $2M+ revenue and #3 nationally in its sector
- Built fully automated invoicing, fulfillment, and reporting; applied analytics to pricing and inventory

Education & Certifications

- **B.S., Life Sciences,** Texas A&M University
- **Business Science University:** Data Science for Business (101P), Python for Data Science Automation (101P-A)